MIL-M-55623A(ER)
23 January 1984
SUPERSEDING
MIL-M-55623(EL)
10 June 1970

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

METER, VOLUME, HYDROGEN-HELIUM ML-605( )/U

This specification is approved for use by Electronics Research and Development Command, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type of meteorological balloon inflation metering device and transit case designated Meter, Volume, Hydrogen-Helium ML-605 ( )/U, and Case CY-4917( )/U respectively (see 6.4).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. Unless otherwise specified, the following specifications and standards of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

FF-N-105 - Nail, Brads, Staples And Spikes; Wire, Cut And Wrought.

MILITARY

MIL-P-11268 - Parts, Materials, And Processes Used In Electronic Equipment.
MIL-M-13231 - Marking Of Electronic Items.
MIL-F-14072 - Finishes For Ground Electronic Equipment.
MIL-E-55585 - Electronic Equipment And Parts, Packaging Of.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Electronics Research and Development Command, Combat Surveillance and Target Acquisition Laboratory, ATTN: DELCS-PE, Fort Monmouth, NJ 07703 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6660

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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures And Tables For Inspection By Attributes.
MIL-STD-726	- Packaging Requirements Code.
MIL-STD-810	- Environmental Test Methods.

2.1.2 Government drawings. The following Government drawings form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

DRAWINGS

ELECTRONICS COMMAND

DL-SM-A-685112	- Meter, Volume, Hydrogen-Helium ML-605( )/U
DL-SM-A-685157	- Case CY-4917( )/U
SM-D-685163	- Helium Inflation Nomograph
SM-D-685164	- Hydrogen Inflation Nomograph

(Copies of specifications, standards and drawings required by manufacturers in connection with specified acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Description. The meter is designed not only to control the flow of gas used to inflate meteorological balloons, but also to measure the flow and record the total volume. The transit case also serves as a storage container.

3.2 First article. When specified (see 6.2) a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3 and 6.3).

3.3 Material. The material shall be as shown on the drawings and as specified herein. However, when a definite material is not specified, a material shall be used which will enable the meters to meet the performance requirements of this specification. Acceptance or approval of any constituent material shall not be construed as a guaranty of the acceptance of the finished product. The requirements of MIL-P-11268 including the selection requirements therein, shall apply.

3.3.1 Recycled, virgin and reclaimed material. It is encouraged that recycled or reclaimed material, in lieu of virgin material, be used when practical provided it meets the requirements of this specification.

3.4 Construction. The meter shall be constructed in accordance with DL-SM-A-685112.

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3.4.1 Transit case. The case shall be constructed in accordance with DL-SM-A-685157.

3.5 Performance.

3.5.1 Delivery rate. The meter shall deliver helium at a rate of not less than 420 cu. ft. (11.89 cu. meters) per hour and hydrogen at a rate of not less than 600 cu.ft. (16.99 cu. meters) per hour (see 4.6.1).

3.5.2 Accuracy. The meter shall measure gas volume to an accuracy of ±3 percent as compared with a test standard (see 4.6.2).

3.5.3 Metering device. The metering device shall automatically compensate for temperature changes between -40°F (-40°C) and 140°F (60°C) including sun-load effects. Consideration will be given to the use of correction factors on the nomograph at the low temperature extremes providing the required accuracy is met (see 4.6.3).

3.5.4 Recording device. The recording device shall be totalizing from 0 to 999.9 cu.ft. (0 to 283 cu. meters). It shall be resettable by the operator at any reading without the use of tools. It shall read to 0.1 cu.ft. (0.0028 cu. meter). The 0.1 digit counter drum shall be a contrasting color to facilitate ease of readability. The recording device shall not require any lubrication (see 4.6.4).

3.5.5 Inflation nomograph. A hydrogen and helium inflation nomograph shall be constructed in accordance with SM-D-685164 and SM-D-685163. The error caused by distortion during the photographic process shall not exceed one minor division on the graph as compared with a master plate. The nomographs (outside of the transit case) shall withstand the same environmental conditions as the volume meter (see 4.6.5).

3.6 Environmental conditions. The meter shall withstand individual environmental conditions specified herein, or combinations thereof, without damage, performance degradation, or malfunction when tested in accordance with 4.6.6.

3.6.1 Nonoperating (storage and transit).

a. Temperature range: -60°F to 154°F (-51.1°C to 67.8°C).
b. Relative humidity: 94 percent in the temperature range of 68°F to 117°F (20°C to 47.2°C) with condensation.
c. Elevation: Up to 50,000 feet (15,240 m) above sea level.
d. Immersion: No leakage into the transit case when immersed to a depth of 3 feet (.91 m).
e. Shock drop: The meter in its transit case shall withstand a 4-foot (1.22 m) drop.
f. Shock bounce: The meter in its transit case shall withstand shocks as may be induced in field use during transporation.

3.6.2 Operating.

a. Temperature range: -40°F to 120°F (-40°C to 49°C) including sun-load effect at 120°F (49°C).
b. Relative humidity: 94 percent with condensation.
c. Elevation: Up to 10,000 feet (3048 m) above sea level.
d. Sand and dust: As encountered in arid regions.

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3.7 Interchangeability. Like units, assemblies, subassemblies, and replaceable parts shall be physically and functionally interchangeable, without modification of such items or of the meter. Individual items shall not be hand-picked for fit or performance.

3.8 Finish. The meter shall be finished in accordance with MIL-F-14072 and as specified on the drawings.

3.9 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-M-13231 and as shown on the drawings.

3.9.1 Caution notice. Each meter shall have a caution notice, either on the name plate or on a separate but attached plate, and shall depict the following:

"Caution: Meter to be used with cylinder gas only."

3.9.2 Serial numbers. All completed meters shall have serial numbers.

3.10 Workmanship. The meter shall be manufactured and assembled in accordance with the requirements of the applicable portions of the following paragraphs listed in MIL-P-11268:

Adhesives
Cleaning (equipment)
  Parts
  Units
Fasteners:
  Security of parts
  Screws, etc.
  Hardware, miscellaneous
Flatwashers
Plastic - material and parts
Rubber
Welding

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specifications where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Inspection covered by subsidiary documents (see 4.4).
c. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).
d. Packaging inspection (see 4.7).

4.3 First article.

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4.3.1 First article units. When required and as specified in the contract, the contractor shall furnish first article units of the complete Meter.

4.3.2 First article inspection. The first article inspection shall consist of the inspections specified in subsidiary documents covering the items listed in 4.4, and the inspections specified for group A, group B and group C (see tables I and II and 4.5.3). The inspections shall be performed in the following order: 4.4, group A and group B for all units, and group C as specified in table II. After completion of group C tests, conforming units shall be reinspected and shall pass all group A inspections. Failure of any inspection shall be cause for rejection.

4.4 Inspection covered by subsidiary documents. The following shall be inspected under the applicable subsidiary documents as part of the inspection required by this specification:

Item	Where required
Finish	3.8
Marking	3.9

4.5 Quality conformance inspection.

4.5.1 Inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall be as specified in 4.4 and 4.5.2 through 4.5.4.3.

4.5.2 Group A inspection. Group A inspection shall be as specified in table I, and the acceptable quality levels (AQL) shall be as stated therein.

TABLE I. Group A inspection.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test method paragraph	AQL (percent defective)	
			Major	Minor
Visual and mechanical	3.10	4.6.8	1	4
Delivery rate	3.5.1	4.6.1	1	
Accuracy	3.5.2	4.6.2	1	
Recording device	3.5.4	4.6.4	1	4
Inflation nomograph	3.5.5	4.6.5	1	4

4.5.2.1 Group A sampling plan. Group A sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level II.

4.5.2.2 Order of inspection. Group A inspection shall be performed in any order which is satisfactory to the Government.

4.5.3 Group B inspection. Group B inspection shall normally be peformed on inspection lots that have passed group A inspection and on samples selected from units that have been subjected to and met the group A inspection. This inspection shall be as specified in 4.6.7.

4.5.3.1 Group B sampling plan. Group B sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-4 for normal and tightened inspection and S-3 for reduced inspection. AQL shall be 6.5 percent defective.

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4.5.4 Group C inspection. Group C inspection shall be performed on units that have passed group A and group B inspection. The inspection shall consist of the inspections specified in table II.

TABLE II. Group C inspection.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test method paragraph
Subgroup 1		
Temperature	3.6.1a, 3.6.2a	4.6.6.1, 4.6.6.2
Immersion	3.6.1d	4.6.6.5
Bounce	3.6.1f	4.6.6.8
Subgroup 2		
Humidity	3.6.1b, 3.6.2b	4.6.6.3
Altitude	3.6.1c, 3.6.2c	4.6.6.4
Dust	3.6.2d	4.6.6.6
Shock drop	3.6.1e	4.6.6.7

4.5.4.1 Group C sampling plan. Two sample units shall be selected at random for submission to each inspection in table II, subgroup 2, from each 150 units or fraction thereof produced. One sample unit shall be selected at random for submission to each inspection in table II, subgroup 1, from each 50 units or a fraction thereof produced. The first samples selected shall be at the start of the contract from the first quality conformance inspection production lot. However, if first article samples are specified, the submission of samples from the initital production lots to both subgroup 1 and subgroup 2 tests will not be required.

4.5.4.2 Order of inspection. Group C inspection shall be performed as specified in 4.5.4.

4.5.4.3 Group C failures. Action required relative to group C failures shall be as specified (see 6.2).

4.6 Methods of inspection.

4.6.1 Delivery rate. Using a test control meter which has been certified and traceable to the National Bureau of Standards, the sample meters shall be tested for the gas delivery rates in 3.5.1 and compared with the certified meter. Nonconformance to 3.5.1 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.2 Accuracy. Using a test control meter which has certification traceable to the National Bureau of Standards, the sample meters shall be tested for accuracy and compared with the certified meter. Nonconformance to 3.5.2 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.3 Metering device (temperature compensator). Using a test control meter which has certification traceable to the National Bureau of Standards, the sample metering device shall be tested for automatic compensating requirements of 3.5.3. Evidence of metering errors of more than three percent shall constitute failure of this test.

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4.6.4 Recording device. The recording device shall be inspected visually and mechanically and the counter shall be reset not less than 5 times. Nonconformance to 3.5.4, the drawings, binding of the shaft, or failure of the counter to return to zero at each reset shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.5 Inflation nomographs. The nomographs shall be visually checked for conformance to the master plates and drawings. Error caused by distortion during the photographic process shall not exceed one minor division on the graph. The nomographs shall be subjected to and pass the same environmental tests that are required for the volume meter. The inflation nomograph shall be subjected to the temperature and humidity test without the protection of the transit case. Nonconformance to 3.5.5 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.6 Environmental.

4.6.6.1 Low temperature. The meter shall be tested in accordance with MIL-STD-810, method 502.1, procedure I. Exposure at the low temperature extreme shall be 6 hours. After temperature stabilization of the meter at -40°F (-40°C), operate the meter for 15 minutes and compare results with those obtained at start of test. Nonconformance to 3.6 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.6.2 High temperature. The meter shall be tested in accordance with MIL-STD-810, method 501.1, procedure II. After temperature stabilization of the meter at the operating temperature, operate the meter for 15 minutes and compare results with those obtained at start of test. Nonconformance to 3.6 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.6.3 Humidity (moisture-resistance). The meter shall be tested in accordance with MIL-STD-810, method 507.1, procedure III. Operate the meter for 15 minutes during the periods shown on the figure for the cycle and compare results with original performance. Do not remove the meter from the humidity chamber for measurements. Step 6 of procedure III is modified by this specification to read, "Subject the test item to two continuous 48-hour cycles in accordance with figure 507.1-2." Steps 7, 8 and 9 shall be omitted. If any meter fails to meet the specified performance during cycling, it shall be realigned or readjusted once and the test continued. No repair or replacement of parts shall be permitted. Nonconformance to 3.6 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.6.4 Altitude (elevation). The meter shall be tested in accordance with MIL-STD-810, method 500.1, procedure I. After temperature and pressure stabilization equivalent to 10,000 ft. (3,048 m) operate the equipment for 15 minutes and compare the performance with that prior to test. Nonconformance to 3.6 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.6.5 Leakage (immersion). The meter, as prepared for field transportation, shall be tested in accordance with MIL-STD-810, method 512.1, procedure I. A dummy load shall be substituted for the meter during this test. Care must be taken to ensure that the breather relief valve on the case is not in the open position. Nonconformance to 3.6 shall constitute failure of this test.

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4.6.6.6 Dust. The equipment, as prepared for operation, shall be tested in accordance with MIL-STD-810, method 510.1, procedure I, modified as follows:

a. Step 2 shall be omitted.
b. Rotate the meter so that all 4 sides will be exposed for an equal period of time through the test.
c. The meter shall be operated for the last 15 minutes of steps 1 and 3 and performance compared with that obtained prior to test. Nonconformance to 3.6 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.6.7 Shock drop. The meter, in its transit case, shall be subjected to the drop test as outlined below:

4.6.6.7.1 Apparatus. Drops shall be made from a quick-release hook or pendulum tester manufactured by Mechanical Technology, Inc. LAB Div., Latham, NY or equal. The floor or barrier receiving the impact shall be 2-inch (50.8 mm) wood (fir) backed by concrete or a rigid steel frame.

4.6.6.7.2 Procedure.

a. Fasten the meter to the quick-release hook and raise it to a height of 4 ft. (1.22 m) above the test platform.

b. By use of the quick-release mechanism (that will not cause a rotational motion), allow the meter to fall freely to the test platform.

c. This test shall be repeated on each corner, edge and face for a total of 26 drops.

d. At the conclusion of the series of drops, inspect the equipment for any evidence of physical damage to the case or meter. The meter shall then be operated for not less than 15 minutes. Nonconformance to 3.6 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.6.8 Bounce. The meter, in its transit case, shall be subjected to the bounce test in accordance with the following procedure.

4.6.6.8.1 Apparatus. A package tester of suitable capacity manufactured by Mechanical Technology, Inc., LAB Div., Latham, NY, or equal.

4.6.6.8.2 Test conditions. The test bed of the package tester shall be covered with a plywood panel having a thickness of .50-inch (12.7 mm) with the wood grain parallel to the drive chain. The plywood shall be secured with 6d common steel nails, conforming to FF-N-105, with top of the heads flush with or slightly below the surface. Nails shall be spaced at 6-inch (152.4 mm) intervals around all four edges. The plywood shall also be nailed at 3-inch (76.2 mm) intervals in a 6-inch (152.4 mm) square at the center of the test area. Using suitable wooden fences, constrain the test item to a horizontal motion of not greater than 2 inches (50.4 mm) in a direction parallel to the axes of the shafts of the package tester, and in a direction perpendicular to the axes of the shafts, a distance more than sufficient to ensure the test item will not rebound from fence to fence.

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4.6.6.8.3 Performance of test. The test item, as secured in its transit case, shall be placed on the package tester within the constraints as specified in 4.6.6.8.2. The package tester shall be operated in the synchronous mode with the shafts in phase. The tester shall be operated at a speed of 284 ± 2 rpm for 3 hours. At the end of each 0.5 hour period, turn the test item to rest on a different face. At the end of the 3-hour period, the test item shall be operated and the results compared with the performance prior to start of test. The meter shall be visually inspected and a record made of any damage resulting from this test. Nonconformance to 3.6 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.7 Dimensional interchangeability. The dimensions listed below shall be gaged or measured to determine conformance to the physical interchangeability requirement of 3.7. When a listed dimension is not within specified or design limits, it shall be considered a major defect.

a. External and internal dimensions of cases, cover, and insertable assemblies, when such dimensions affect mating of parts.

b. Dimensions of cavities, when such dimensions affect insertion of items.

c. Location of hinges and fasteners on separable parts or assemblies which must mate, such as cases, covers, and mountings.

d. Size and form of special threads.

4.6.8 Visual and mechanical inspections. The meter, including case CY-4917 ( )/U shall be inspected for the workmanship items listed in 3.10 and for those items covered by subsidiary documents in 4.4. Construction and physical dimensions shall be inspected for conformance to the equipment drawings. Nonconformance to 3.10, 4.4, and the construction and physical dimensions shown on the drawings shall constitute failure of this test.

4.7 Packaging inspection. Packaging inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection of packaging.
b. Quality conformance inspection of packaging.

4.7.1 First article inspection of packaging. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, first article inspection of packaging shall be in accordance with the unit pack design validation requirements of MIL-P-116.

4.7.2 Quality conformance inspection of packaging.

4.7.2.1 Materials inspection. All materials to be used in packaging shall be inspected in accordance with the applicable material specification.

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4.7.2.2 Preservation inspection. Inspection of preservation and interior markings shall be in accordance with group A and B quality conformance inspection requirements of MIL-P-116. Lot formation and sampling procedures shall be as specified therein.

4.7.2.3 Packing inspection. Inspection of packing and the marking for shipment and storage shall consist of the examinations specified in table III, "Packing inspection provisions." Lot formation shall consist of all packs made of the same materials during an identifiable period and submitted at one time for acceptance. Sampling procedures shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, using a single sampling plan and acceptable quality level of 4.0 percent defective.

TABLE III. Packing inspection provisions.

No.	Characteristic	Method of inspection
101	Intermediate container not as specified.	Visual
102	Improper closure of intermediate container.	Visual
103	Shipping containers not in accordance with specification.	Visual
104	Excessive cube.	Visual
105	Improper blocking and bracing.	Visual
106	Closure not in accordance with specification.	Visual
107	Weight and size exceed container limitations.	Weight and measure
108	Strapping not in accordance with specification, incorrectly applied, or omitted.	Visual
109	Marking omitted, incorrect, or illegible	Visual

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be as specified in MIL-STD-726, coded as follows:

5.1.1 Level A. JR-1-1-ØØ-00-NS-X-ED-Ø-00-A.

5.1.2 Level B. JR-1-1-ØØ-00-NS-X-ED-Ø-00-B.

5.2 Packing and marking. Packing and marking shall be in accordance with MIL-E-55585.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The Meter, Volume, Hydrogen-Helium ML-605( )/U is used to give a direct readout of total gas volume appplied during the inflation of meteorological balloons.

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6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. When a first article is required for inspection and approval (see 3.2).
c. Group C failure action (see 4.5.4.3).
d. Level A or B preservation and packing (see section 5).
e. When first article inspection rough handling tests are not required.
f. When first article packaging inspection test reports require acquisition activity approval prior to production unit packing.

6.3 First article. When a first article inspection is required, the item will be tested and should be a first article sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, test, approval, and the number of first article units.

6.4 Nomenclature. The parenthesis in the nomenclature will be deleted or replaced by a letter identifying the particular design; for example: ML-605W/U. The contractor should apply for nomenclature in accordance with the applicable clause in the contract.

6.5 Level B preservation. When level B preservation is specified, this level of protection will only be used under known favorable conditions during transportation, storage and handling.

6.6 Environmental. Environmental pollution prevention measures are contained in the packaging material specifications referenced herein. Refer to material specifications or preparing activity for recommended disposability methods.

6.7 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodian:
Army - ER

Preparing activity:
Army - ER

(Project 6660-A071)

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions - Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-M-55623A(ER)	METER, VOLUME, HYDROGEN-HELIUM ML-605( )/U

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS *(Street City State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last First MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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